

"Welcome, ms. Olivetti, to our humble department!" said mr. Phil Cortana, her new boss - or as he was named, Labour Assigner level 1.01. He waved her into the hallway of the 11th floor. The lights were rather dim, but the solar power hadn't the force at 7 seven o'clock in the morning to power them properly. It was still dark outside and it was a glum sight. The Westelijk Havengebied was populated with morose and rickety ships, cranes delapidated forking crummy metal waste into big bins meant for resmelting. in the forges that were once ??? belching brown clouds of lignite exhaust

! - add something about The data box ->

mr Cortana wiggled his eyebrows and he gestured for her coat to hang on the sparwe and dripping coatrack in the corner of the hallway, "Pass me your coat please, ms," he said, and she quickly though clumsily took off her coat and grotty scarf.

"What a nice view." she crooned. "I always wondered how far one could see from this impressive building!" *Is That The Data Archive?*

"oh yes, well this isn't the half of it, just wait until you see old Schoten when it gets lighter!" he puffed with pride, as if he had personally designed the view himself. He hung up her coat and scarf, holding it as if it was a wet cat, far away from him. ~~She inspected his demeanour.~~ He was ~~dressed~~ ^{- and every day -} that day in khaki slacks and ironed to perfection and a white dress shirt that was old and a bit tatty around the wrists, but again, fastidious creases. He shook his ^{ostentatiously} left hand so that his wristwatch emerged from under his sleeve. ~~It seemed he wanted her to notice his watch.~~ Obviously she couldn't give a rat's ass, but understood that it would flatter her new boss's ego, and therefore was an invitation she couldn't nor shouldn't refuse. Better yet it would probably go quite a way towards getting her first PosPoint.

"Wow," exclaimed Dora with fitting surprise, "Is that a 20th century Seiko or Casio? I'm impressed, it's quite the ordeal to keep them old LCD's going!"

"Thank you, that's quite right, it's a 1990 Seiko, and i found some old batteries in my late father's inheritance." Again Phil shook his left wrist in that irritating manner befitting hirsute middle-aged men of Mediterranean descent. Dora complimented him on his restoration skills, but though he was a doofus because he didn't know how to adjust the ^{metal} wrist strap/chain to fit his wrist better. "I suppose taking good care of old materials is an merit for this job, isn't it?"

"Absolutely," chuffed Phil, his unibrow wiggling like a fat black caterpillar, "And your powers of observation and ^{antiques} is also duly noted!" Follow me, I'll show you your workcounter and introduce you to your two primary labour comrades." He shuffled forward out of the antechamber and the new cognitariat drudge came onto the workflow that was a giant expanse of small desks and monk-like scribes poring over lowlit computer screens and tapping away at high speeds. the sound of locusts a constant droning that was rather calming in a rather numbing fashion. His shuffling gait speed up as he nimbly flitted/slalomed from left to right through the labyrinthine office.

CHAPTER X - ZONING FOR SUCCESS / PHIL'S DEMISE /2

Somewhere left to the middle of the labyrinth Phil came to a stop after his ballet through the office space. "Well here she is, your new mitarbeiter, ms. Dora Olivetti" the two drudges looked up, both bespectacled, simultaneously.

out of habit as not to appear like ~~a~~ intelligentia, they also took off their glasses simultaneously. Their blinking eyes showed that they had had ample experience with the Voigt-Kampf tests (—) and blushing cheeks. The man, a bit pudgy and squint in his left eye, had a stoop and hulking size, and a hard handshake and pumped her hand up and down like a piston. "Erwin, Erwin Fischer/Adler is the name, nice to meet you," he said, his voice ^{soft} ~~pleasant~~ if a bit monotonous. Despite his squinty blue eye, he made quite the effort to pin my gaze down, and his hand was becoming sweaty and uncomfortable. ~~ix~~ The other drudge, rather more handsome with spiky blonde hair and a pixie smile, welcomed me, "C'mon, Erwin, give her a bit of a rest from that fierce grip, hi, I'm Tricia, Tricia Hermes, I do retro-wiping ~~of~~ specially of left-wing climatefreaks, and niche feminists of the nineteen-eighties," and she shook my hand, nudging away Erwin, who grimaced clumsily and grasped for his glasses. "Oh, and ^{Erwin} here is the expert in the Auditing Laws and Bylaws, especially the section 28ths," continued Tricia. I smiled and bobbed my head like a proper little newbie bumpkin, following mr Cortana's mien from the corner of my beady eye, knowing that the flourish I'd had coming in was no guarantee for success. ^{21-2 dialogue} A little person in the cogwheels of the gruelling bureaucracy like dear old unibrow Phil, who had insignificant and futile KPIs, OKRs, OGSMs and peurile assessments to complete, who may once have aspired to become a Blade Runner ~~or~~ had not gotten much further than level fifty as a Pokemon catcher. — and he ^{—>} knew it, the limits of his career — and self-esteem where ~~as~~ marked as his unibrow. Indeed, he needed no Voigt-Kampff test — he had his unibrow, and it was twitching like a spastic hairy caterpillar. "Well, thanks guys, look forward to learning from you, especially you, mr Cortana!" The caterpillar calmed significantly and he said, "Ok, let's move on, now, and Tricia, don't forget ^{to tip} those passages about alternative green energy sources like ion drives, subspace plotters and hyperdrives, and solar parasols," and he waved a long skinny finger to boot. Tricia nodded and got back to her desk, swooping up her glasses and tapping with one hand before her visual protheiss had been perched on her nose. "Let me show you my office, where you're expected to report at five o'clock in the afternoon everyday this month. It's also where you go to receive PosPoints — if so deserved — and NegPoints — only a stimuli to perform better of course. Everything is personally evaluated by me. The four eye principle of course. I'm not yet involved in machinated evaluations, but this will probably not be anytime soon, — I've been in this job almost twenty years — yes approaching my well-earned promotion to level 201 Labour Evaluator, no mean feat — so you are learning from the best, Dora, I mean ms. Olivetti. //